

Introduction

The piracy rates are so high, that Free software does not really mean much to the regular computer user. The reasoning is that since all of it is free anyway, what's the big difference between pirated software and freeware. This however, is not the case.

A lot of free software out there is designed and coded by individuals and communities that saw a serious lack in the functionality of existing software. There is no commercial need to create and market a product that is an alternative to Windows Explorer, no one would buy such a product. However, a free alternative file explorer, by the name of Midnight Commander, with simple and thoughtful features such as a folder size display and batch renaming capabilities, outshines Windows Explorer. For mysterious reasons, free software tend to have drastically smaller file sizes, and memory footprints than their commercial counterparts. Wavepad is a fully featured sound editor, which takes less than 500 KB of the system space. Free software is simple to use, with advanced capabilities hidden away till you require them. IrfanView and uTorrent are both examples of such software.

These benefits are true for almost every free software in existence, and there is a free software for every task you might want to perform on your computer, from batch encoding audio files to cleaning up the system registry. This Fast Track tackles each task as a workshop, with step-by-step instructions on how to accomplish specific tasks with freeware.